ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 9 · SET 05

Max. Marks: 80 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct methods to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions — 20 questions · 20 marks

Select the most appropriate option. (20 × 1 = 20)

1. The high seas, or international waters, cover about _____ per cent of the world's oceans.

(a) 12 (b) 30 (c) 90 (d) 64

Ans: (d) They are part of the global commons.

2. On a Production Possibility Curve, a point lying outside the curve represents a combination that is:

(a) inefficient
(b) not attainable with the present resources
(c) the cheapest
(d) the most equal

Ans: (b) Inside = under-use; on = efficient; outside = unattainable.

3. Which of the following regions is identified as a biodiversity hotspot in India?

(a) The Deccan lava plateau interior (b) The Western Ghats
(c) The Thar sand dunes only (d) The Ganga delta mudflats only

Ans: (b) Others: Himalaya, North-East India, Andaman & Nicobar Islands.

4. Nalanda in ancient India was famous as a centre of:

(a) shipbuilding (b) salt production
(c) learning (d) horse trade

Ans: (c) A great ancient university in Magadha.

5. The policy of ‘Sulh-i-kul’ associated with Akbar stood for:

(a) peace with all and universal toleration (b) conquest of the Deccan
(c) reduction of land tax (d) rule by the nobles

Ans: (a) Part of the inclusive approach in his later reign.

6. **Assertion (A):** Citizens in India can obtain information about how public money is spent.
Reason (R): The Right to Information Act, 2005 allows citizens to request information from public authorities.

Ans: (a) RTI is a tool for transparency.

7. Income, in personal finance, means the money a person receives:

(a) only as gifts
(b) only from banks
(c) only as a loan
(d) regularly or occasionally in return for products sold or services rendered

Ans: (d) It is the starting point of personal finance.

8. Traditionally, the Indian calendar describes the year in terms of how many ṛtus (seasons)?

(a) Two (b) Four (c) Eight (d) Six

Ans: (d) The IMD recognises four seasons.

9. Startups valued at over 1 billion US dollars are known as:

(a) mortgages (b) unicorns (c) bonds (d) guyots

> **Ans: (b)** India had around 120 unicorns in 2025.

10. A policy becomes a ‘public policy’ when it is:

(a) decided by a company for its staff
(b) made by one family for itself
(c) made for public benefit and implemented by public institutions
(d) kept secret from citizens

> **Ans: (c)** Often financed by taxes.

11. Which of the following will increase the supply of mangoes in a market, other things remaining the same?

(a) an improvement in cold-storage technology
(b) a ban on the sale of mangoes
(c) a fall in the number of sellers
(d) a rise in cost of every input

> **Ans: (a)** Technology lowers costs and raises supply.

12. Guru Tegh Bahādur, the ninth Sikh Guru, was executed on the orders of Aurangzeb in:

(a) 1605 (b) 1675 (c) 1556 (d) 1739

> **Ans: (b)** His martyrdom was a turning point.

13. Which of the following is a depositional landform made by waves?

(a) A sea arch (b) A sea cave (c) A stump (d) A beach

> **Ans: (d)** Erosional: crack, cave, arch, stack, stump.

14. **Assertion (A):** Earthquakes are common along the boundaries of tectonic plates.
Reason (R): Plates move relative to each other because of convection currents in the mantle.

> **Ans: (a)** Relative movement at boundaries causes earthquakes.

15. Which of the following is a function of political parties in a democracy?

(a) Forming the government or acting as the opposition
(b) Counting votes at polling booths
(c) Drawing constituency boundaries
(d) Appointing the Chief Election Commissioner

> **Ans: (a)** Parties contest elections and give choice to voters.

16. At the base of a biome pyramid are the:

(a) carnivores (b) decomposers only
(c) producers such as plants and algae (d) top predators

> **Ans: (c)** Energy decreases at each higher trophic level.

17. A fixed amount paid regularly by an insured person to the insurance company is the:

(a) dividend (b) principal (c) premium (d) dues

> **Ans: (c)** In return, the company compensates for covered losses.

18. The first metal used by the Chalcolithic people was:

(a) copper (b) iron (c) gold (d) tin

> **Ans: (a)** Chalcolithic = copper-stone age.

19. The Constitution of India came into force in:

(a) 1947 (b) 1935 (c) 1976 (d) 1950

> **Ans: (d)** Republic Day, 26 January 1950.

20. In a market where the quantity supplied exceeds the quantity demanded at the current price, the price tends to:

(a) rise (b) fall

(c) remain fixed for ever (d) become zero immediately

> **Ans: (b)** Excess supply pushes price down towards equilibrium.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Type — 4 questions · 8 marks

Each question carries 2 marks. Answer in about 40 words. (4 × 2 = 8)

21. Name any two greenhouse gases and state one effect of their increasing concentration.

> Any two (½ each): carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, water vapour (1). Effect: global warming / climate change (1).

22. What is ecotourism? Name India's first planned ecotourism destination and its State.

> Responsible travel to natural areas that conserves nature and benefits local people (1). Thenmala in Keralam (1).

OR

Differentiate between a biome and an ecosystem.

> Biome – a large region with similar climate, plants and animals (1); ecosystem – a smaller neighbourhood within a biome where living and non-living things interact closely (1).

23. What is income tax? Distinguish between a direct tax and an indirect tax with one example each.

> Income tax – tax paid on income earned in a financial year (½). Direct – paid directly on income/profit, e.g., income tax (¾). Indirect – added to the price of goods/services, e.g., GST (¾).

24. Write any two features of village administration in ancient India.

> Any two (1 each): villages largely autonomous; village councils/assemblies; elections for council members (Uttaramerur); officials collected revenue and settled disputes.

SECTION C — Short Answer Type — 5 questions · 15 marks

Each question carries 3 marks. Answer in about 60 words. (5 × 3 = 15)

25. Describe the role of guilds, trade routes and ports in the economy of ancient and early medieval India.

> Guilds organised crafts and trade (1); trade routes and ports linked regions and overseas lands (1); surplus agriculture, irrigation supported markets and revenue (1).

26. Classify marine resources into living and non-living and give two examples of each. Why are they important for coastal countries like India?

> Living: fish and seafood, biodiversity/coral reefs (1). Non-living: oil and gas, minerals, sand, tidal/wave energy (1). Importance: food, livelihood, trade, energy (1).

27. Explain how the electoral process in India ensures that voting is fair. Mention three points.

> Electoral rolls with adult franchise (1); model code of conduct and ECI supervision (1); secret ballot/EVMs and counting under observers (1).

OR

Why are political parties necessary in a multi-party system? Give three reasons.

Offer choices to voters (1); form government and opposition (1); frame policies and connect people with government (1).

28. Explain how the story of Lijjat Papad shows entrepreneurship and community strength. Give three points.

Seven women began in 1959 with ₹80 and borrowed equipment (1); cooperative with equal ownership, shared profits; registered 1962 (1); grew to 45,000+ women members and 83 branches, scholarships for children, women's financial independence (1).

29. What is a monopoly? Why does the government regulate monopolies?

A market with a single seller of a good with no close substitutes (1). Regulation prevents high prices and exploitation (1); ensures fair competition and consumer protection (1).

SECTION D — Long Answer Type — 4 questions · 20 marks

Each question carries 5 marks. Answer in about 120 words. (4 × 5 = 20)

30. Describe the stages of human development from the Palaeolithic to the Iron Age with one important feature of each stage.

Palaeolithic – hunter-gatherers, stone tools (1); Mesolithic – microliths, fishing (1); Neolithic – farming, villages, Mehrgarh (1); Chalcolithic – copper (1); Bronze and Iron Ages – metal tools, cities, trade (1).

OR

Describe the Mesopotamian civilisation under the following heads: location, major states, writing and economy.

Between Tigris and Euphrates (1); Sumer, Akkad, Assyria, Babylon (1.5); cuneiform on clay tablets (1.25); farming, irrigation, trade and cities (1.25).

31. Describe how the Vijayanagara Empire resisted the expansion of the Delhi Sultanate and why it fell in 1565.

Founded in 1336 by Harihara and Bukkā to check the Sultanate (1); strong natural defence – river and rocky terrain (1); Kumāra Kampana ended the Madurai Sultanate (1); peak under Kṛiṣhṇadevarāya (1); Talikota 1565, alliance of Deccan sultanates, sack of the city (1).

OR

Explain how the Marathas under Chhatrapati Śhivājī organised resistance to the Mughals. Mention forts and swarajya.

Idea of swarājya – self-rule (1); hill-valley terrain and guerrilla warfare (1); network of forts like Raigad, Sinhagad, Senji – outposts, fallback capitals, administration (2); long wars exhausted Mughals; Aurangzeb in the Deccan for over two decades (1).

32. What are the challenges before Indian democracy? Suggest ways in which citizens can strengthen it.

Fake news, inequality, illiteracy, misuse of power (2.5); informed, responsible citizens, participation, voting, RTI, vigilance (2.5).

OR

Describe the Fundamental Rights provided by the Constitution of India. How do they protect democracy?

Six rights – equality, freedom, against exploitation, freedom of religion, cultural and educational, constitutional remedies (3); they protect individuals from arbitrary power, ensure equality and enable participation (2).

33. Explain the five pillars of personal finance and why each is important to a family.

Earning/income (1); spending (1) – needs vs wants, budget; saving (1); investing (1); protection through insurance (1).

OR

Explain the roles of any five stakeholders in making and implementing public policy with suitable examples.

Elected representatives – raise issues; government departments – design and deliver; experts/researchers/NGOs – advice and awareness; media – informs; citizens – feedback; international organisations – support (any five, 1 each).

SECTION E — Source-based / Case-based Questions — 3 questions · 12 marks

Each question carries 4 marks (1 + 1 + 2). (3 × 4 = 12)

34. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"Sita has ₹300 to spend this month on notebooks or a visit to a science fair; she cannot afford both. Her neighbour Ali thinks she should buy notebooks because they are a need. A third friend, Dev, feels the fair is a want but will give her new ideas. Each of them prefers a different choice because every choice leaves something else unfulfilled."

(i) Name the basic economic problem that makes Sita choose.

Scarcity (limited resources).

(ii) Identify the need and the want in the passage.

Need – notebooks; want – visit to the science fair.

(iii) Define opportunity cost and state Sita's opportunity cost if she goes to the fair.

Value of the next best alternative given up (1). Opportunity cost = the notebooks (1).

35. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"Thenmala in Kollam district of Keralam is India's first planned ecotourism destination. It lies in the Western Ghats, a UNESCO World Heritage Site. The project was developed jointly by the Tourism, Forest and Irrigation Departments. Local inhabitants are employed as guides, eco-guards and service providers, so that the benefits of tourism are shared. It combines recreation, environmental education and conservation."

(i) Name the mountain range in which Thenmala is located.

Western Ghats.

(ii) Name any two departments that developed the project.

Any two of Tourism, Forest, Irrigation.

(iii) Explain how ecotourism differs from mass tourism and why Thenmala is called a model.

Ecotourism has minimal environmental impact, respects locals and educates (1); Thenmala balances recreation, conservation and community livelihood (1).

36. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"In the Uttaramerur village of the Chola period, officials had to be chosen by drawing lots from eligible candidates, who had to meet qualifications of age, property and honest conduct. People who had held office could not stand again for some years. Written rules ensured that the village council worked in a regular, accountable manner."

(i) Which dynasty ruled during the period mentioned?

Chola.

(ii) What was the method of choosing officials?

Drawing lots from eligible candidates.

(iii) State two rules that made the village council accountable.

> Qualifications for candidates (1); disqualification of repeat/misconduct and fixed tenure (1).

SECTION F — Map-based Question — 1 questions · 5 marks

(1 × 5 = 5)

37. On the outline map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following (use the given letter/number for each): *Attempt any five. Each item carries 1 mark.*

A. Udaipur (Mewar)
B. Kanchipuram
C. Udhagamandalam (Nilgiri Hills)
D. Rann of Kutch (salt desert)
E. Sohra (Cherrapunji)
F. Ujjain

Note — in lieu of Q.37, for visually impaired candidates only (answer any five):

1. Name the State/UT in which Udaipur is located.
2. Name the State/UT in which Kanchipuram is located.
3. Name the State/UT in which Udhagamandalam is located.
4. Name the State/UT in which Rann of Kutch is located.
5. Name the State/UT in which Sohra is located.
6. Name the State/UT in which Ujjain is located.

> 1 mark for each correctly located and labelled item (any five). Correct positions are shown below; answers marked within a tolerance of about 150 km are acceptable.

